

Table of Contents

Introduction to Music.....	3
Bells - Sensorial.....	5
How to Carry and Strike the Bell.....	5
Matching.....	8
Games.....	10
Establishing Up and Down.....	11
High and Low.....	13
Grading.....	15
Games.....	16
Whole Steps and Half Steps.....	17
Tetrachord.....	19
Name Lessons with the Bells.....	20
Notation.....	22
Introduction to the Musical Staff.....	22
Note-Names on the Staff.....	24
Exercises.....	25
Music Charts for the Bells.....	27
Exercises.....	28
Naming Sharps and Flats.....	29
Notation of Sharps and Flats.....	32
Naming Scales.....	34
Diatonic Major Scale.....	34
Chromatic Scale.....	35
Pentatonic Scale.....	36
Whole Tone Scale.....	37
Writing Music.....	39
Pitch Dictation.....	41
Singing.....	41
Notation.....	42
Notation of F Clef.....	44
Explore Clefs.....	45
Singing.....	46
Introduction.....	46
Teaching a Song.....	48
Singing with a Scale.....	50
Creativity with Lyrics.....	51
Singing in the Elementary Class.....	51
Movement.....	52
Introduction.....	52
Movement for Control.....	53
Exercises for Body Control and Movement.....	53
Exercises for Body Awareness.....	53
Exercises for Equilibrium.....	54
Silence Exercise.....	54

Movement for Expression.....	55
Games.....	58
Accents.....	59
Dynamics.....	60
Tempo.....	62
Rhythm.....	64
Clapping Four-Beat Measure Patterns.....	64
Introduction to Note Patterns.....	64
Naming and Notation of Note Values.....	66
Summary of Rests.....	69
Equivalence with Dotted Notes.....	70
Tone Bars.....	71
Sensorial introduction.....	71
Naming and Notation of Tone Bars.....	74
Naming.....	74
Notation.....	75
Name of the Degrees of the Scale.....	78
Intervals.....	80
Sequence of Major Scales - Sharps.....	82
Sequence of Major Scales - Flats.....	85
Key Signatures.....	88
Sharps.....	88
Flats.....	89
Transposition of Simple Songs.....	91
Appendix.....	93

Introduction to Music

There are the physical needs for the body. There are spiritual needs that meet the needs of the soul. Included in the spiritual territory are art, religion and music. And all three are in certain ways, a language. All three are used to communicate an idea of the universe. We use paint, color, stone, metal, gold, silver, etc. - a variety of media – for art. In religion, we communicate the idea of a being greater than we are – and how this being should be approached and addressed.

In music, ideas are not communicated in the sounds of human speech – but in tone and pitch. It's a language which gives expression to the human spirit. As human culture developed, language and music became a function of society, a function of cooperation and agreement – an agreement of sounds and order.

Though language and music rely and are founded on order, they are both also a mystery and a magic. They can inspire and enthrall. They can lift the human to new heights of achievement. But they can be dangerous and drag-down and degrade. They can move humans to love but also to hate. Both spoken and musical language can be full of meaning but also be meaningless and worthless.

We must be fully aware of the creative force of the imagination. The child's mind is like a fertile field ready to receive what will germinate into culture. We must sow as many seeds as possible so we must be interested in ALL subjects.

The child generally comes into the primary class speaking his own language complete with grammar and syntax. **As teachers, we then help the child make four more discoveries about his language.** The child will come to make the same four discoveries about music.

First, there are more words than he already knows. The child is fascinated with new words and this is the sensitive period for language. In music, the period includes songs, tunes without words, impromptu phrases played on the bells, as well as listening to longer orchestral pieces.

Get the music work going in the primary class. Anna Maccheroni said, “Just as the child's sensitive, or critical, period for learning language is from two to five years, the **critical period for learning music is from three to five years.** During the early years, the child is especially attuned to, or 'ready' for specific kind of learning. When he receives appropriate assistance and ample stimulation during the various critical periods, he learns easily and accurately. Later, other capabilities develop that distract from the total concentration of the child, so that more effort will be required to learn the skills that could have been easily acquired earlier. Therefore, it is necessary to help the child at this time, the sensitive period for music, from three to five years of age.” Developing the Musical Senses (Greenwood Press).

Second discovery is that the child can make his language visible – and this is true for music as well. The child can write music and make it visible to others through the use of the staff and placement of the notes. Just like the magic of sandpaper letters, this lesson should be an exciting discovery for the child – not a lesson of reading and writing.

Third discovery is that the child can interpret the thoughts of others, though they may be far away or may have lived long ago. In learning to read music, to attach the sound to the little symbol he sees, the child is able to read and play tunes composed by those from other parts of the world and other periods of history.

The fourth discovery is that words, whether carried in the head or visible on paper, carry out a function and are grouped in a certain order. This function and order allow words to have meaning to convey thought. It's the same with music. The tones of music are arranged into phrases, and they, in turn, into passages. Music has a form.

We need to have knowledge of and have practiced with the material to convey these things. The child should know the sounds, notation and how to sight-read music, just as he should have learned to read and write his mother-tongue. With that foundation, the child coming into the elementary class can take the language of music he has built up and explore its history, its writers and its forms. He should be able to create music for himself, just as we're going to help him do with the language he developed in the first plane having to do with his own people and nation. As Dr. Montessori said, “No one language is rich enough to give expression to the gushing life within.”

For too long teaching music in elementary school has been confined to the specialists and for too long teachers have thought of themselves as illiterate in the music language. Eric Gill, an English artist said, **“the artist is not a special kind of man but every man is a special kind of artist.”** We must apply the same idea to music. We must be open to musical expression in ourselves as teachers. We only complicate things when we consider that music only belongs to specialists. What we need to become is that person who is a special kind of musician.

January 3, 2005

Bells - Sensorial



How to Carry and Strike the Bell

Prologue

The bells are expensive (over \$1000) – a finely tuned instrument needing special care. They should be treated carefully. Use a damp cloth to clean them. Do NOT use metal polish on them. They will not tarnish and the polish will distort the sound. Avoid touching the metal to keep oil off of them. The bells are off limits when the children are using magnets as they also distort their sound. Once they are warped or distorted they cannot be corrected.

Bell material is unusual since it is used where it is stored. The bell cabinet should be placed so the bells cannot be seen or played from the wrong side. This is because this spacing (on the instrument) has a great deal of meaning and we want the child to absorb the correct spacing and structure which is symbolic of the actual pitch structure within the scale. Older sets of bells have a high c# and variations of spaces on the boards. White bells are the control of error and with one exception, stay on the boards. **Brown bells can be moved to the children's tables.**

This presentation shows how to carry and the proper technique used with the bell. We carry the bell with both hands. Invite the child to the bell cabinet and choose any brown bell. Pick it up using the thumb and two fingers to hold the stem and place the base on the palm of other hand. Walk to a table and set it down gently and carefully. Go back to the bell cabinet and carry the mallet and damper to the table.

To strike the bell, hold the mallet from top loosely so the mallet swings freely. Arm and mallet are perpendicularly - swinging freely by gravity.

Strike the **rim** of the bell and stand quietly **until you hear the end** of the sound. Give the child a turn and then sing with the bell, inviting the child to sing with it as well. Never insist the child sing alone. Once the child can carry one bell carefully and

strike it correctly, they are free to come to the cabinet and take any **brown bell** for exploration.

After the children have done exploration, we hope they will explore all the brown bells together. We want the children to feel free to come to the instrument and make up simple tunes, playing simple melodies we may have been singing in the class.

Purpose

Help the children focus on one sound and show them how to get a clear tone.

Age

Three years old.

Material

Two green boards with 8 white and 5 black spaces. Spaces are the same size as the base of the bells. The spaces, when on the shelf, the black and white spaces go the front of the board toward the player.

White spaces are arranged so they show the relationships of the pitches of the C major scale. Black spaces are between the white spaces. Each board has ½ black space that go together when set up.

There are 8 white bells – one for each pitch of the C major scale (C-B plus C octave). White bells serve as control of error and are placed behind the white spaces on the board. There are 8 brown bells identical in tone to the white bells that are placed on the white spaces in front of their corresponding mates.

There are two mallets and there are two dampers. A damper stops sound and a mute changes sound – these are dampers.

Begin

(strike the bell)

Let's listen again for the end of the sound.

(strike bell again)

(repeat strike, using damper as well – several times)

If you like you can sing with me. (sing after striking it again)

Would you like a turn striking the bell as I've done?

(return the bell in one trip, mallet and damper in another trip – to the cabinet)

Epilogue

They will explore the bells on their own. Make sure to emphasize dramatically how to treat the bells. If they are rough, eagerly demonstrate again how to be gentle with full technique. They will gradually be able to apply whatever knowledge

of music they may already have acquired.

January 3, 2005

Matching

Purpose

To hear the sound and the development of musical memory – ability to hold a sound and hear music in the mind

Age

Three to Four

Material

Regular bells setup: White bells, corresponding brown bells, mallet and damper plus two green boards with black and white spaces.

Prologue

For individual or small group. Before beginning this exercise and each subsequent exercise, play the “check” (up the brown bells and down the white bells) to make sure bells are in correct positions. The check sounds up and down the C scale.

Begin

(place brown a, f and low c (or other 3 widely spaced tones) on cabinet for player;
move those 3 brown bells off the green boards, all the way to the right, in front of the bell setup – testing each for a match to our c below – see below :-)



*advanced example – initially, choose notes far spread from each other (e.g., d, g, and b);
one-by-one - brown bells are matched to their white mates and put back on the boards.*

(start matching with white bells – low c)

(play the first white bell (low c), listen and stop the tone)

(now play first brown bell at far left – should not be a match)

(shake head emphatically “no” - move it to the left a bit from the remaining two, to show it was not a match)



(KEEP SILENT during all this – to keep focus on the tones)

(repeat for same white c bell – entire process – trying next brown bell for a match)

(on third and final bell – we find a match – shake head emphatically “yes”)

(place brown C bell in front of its mate and play both bells to check the match)

(move unmatched brown bells all the way to the right and repeat the same process until all the bells are matched)

(invite the **child to use the bells** in the same manner **while you are present**)

Epilogue

Note that the child knows which white bells to match since their brown mate is missing, i.e., they are arrayed at the bottom of cabinet.

Gradually add bells until the children are able to match all the bells. This is a matching exercise so the child can start matching any white bell they like.

The bells not only train the ear, but everyone else also hears the bells in the

class as well; they also learn through 'osmosis' in effect.

Games

Take all brown bells and mix them up on a small cabinet (use tray for the decimal materials) plus mallet and damper.

Play the distance game using the bells. Choose a white bell, pulling it forward to distinguish it. Play it and ask child to find the match, trying all brown bells remotely placed. Have child bring the brown bell back the play the check as control of error. Choose another white bell and continue until all brown bells are matched.

Second game: Take all brown bells as with first game. Pick white bell, play it after pulling it forward. **Walk around the room for a short time**, before going to find its brown-bell match. Continue until all white bells are matched.

Game Three: Repeat as in games 1 and 2, but **this time go and talk to someone** before going to the cabinet of brown bells to find the match. Continue until all bells are matched.

Game Four: As above, but play many white bells at random after playing the white bell to be matched. Then, go and find the match. We are working on tonal memory here.

Game five: This is a game with bells off of the boards. You need 16 children (or use as many pairs of bells as you have pairs of children). Line up two rows – one brown bells and one white bells – in random order, and match them one by one beginning with the first white bell. **When the mate is found, reorder the brown child across from the white bell mate.** Teacher, at end, grades the bells back onto the boards, having the children place their bells back in the correct board location.

Once the black bells have been introduced, matching all other games can be done with 13 pairs.

January 3, 2005

Establishing Up and Down

Purpose

Orients the children to higher and lower tones in music. Establish which way is higher and lower in music.

Prerequisites

How to strike and carry a bell.

Age

Three to Four

Material

Regular bell setup.

Begin

(play the check – scale up brown bells and scale down white bells)

(using 3-period lesson, introduce idea of higher and lower tones in music)

(play up the scale from low-C)

This is playing up the scale. The sound gets higher. Listen.

(play up the scale from low-C)

(play down the scale from high-C)

This is playing down the scale. The sound gets lower. Listen.

(play down the scale from high-C)

Second Period *(always the longest period)*

(ask the child or children to play up or down the scale)

Third Period

(ask the child to tell what was done after playing up or down the scale. Then ask them to close their eyes and do the same.)

Epilogue

Whenever possible, try to incorporate physical activity. For example, raise the hand and arm as the scale is played up; lower hand and arm when playing down the scale. “When I play up the scale, raise your arms upward. When I play down the scale, lower your arms.”

Once this lesson is introduced, **we can go to a lesson called “Singing with the Scale”** from the singing chapter.

January 3, 2005

High and Low

Material

Regular bell setup

Prerequisite

How to Strike and Carry a Bell and Establishing Up and Down.

Purpose

Establish high and low or up and down in music.

Begin

(play the check)

(use 3-period lesson to introduce the concept – be sure to pick tones of great contrast)

First Period

(move low c forward, strike it and sing the phrase...)

This is a low bell.

(move the b above forward, strike it and sing the phrase...)

This is a high bell.

(repeat)

Second Periods

(play two tones)

Show me the low bell.

Show me the high bell.

(repeat)

Third Period

(singing)

Sometimes I'm high.

Sometimes I'm low.

Which is this?

(play a tone)

(repeat)

Epilogue

Encourage the children to physically act out high and low – stretching bodies up and down.

If in the temperate zone, name the fruit that might be picked – pumpkins for low tones, tomatoes for middle tones, apples for high tones – for example.

Find out who has the highest and lowest voices in the class or in the children's family.

Do listening exercises with songs the children already know. For example, find the highest note in a song. The children can raise the hand when the highest note is played.

Play a song and leave out the high (low) note to call attention to it.

January 3, 2005

Grading

Material

Regular bell setup.

Age

Three to Four

Indirect Preparation

Hearing Playing the Check and Singing the Scale in the background.

Prerequisite

Matching. Grading must follow matching developmentally.

Begin

(play check - **randomize brown bells at bottom and right of the cabinet** (off the board) for the player)

(for **first white bell**, test each brown bell for a match)

(non-matches are moved leftward)

(a match is moved to its mate position, back onto the board)

(play the match pair for low C once found)

(for **second white bell**, test each brown bell for a match)

(non-matches are moved leftward)

(a match is moved to its mate position, back onto the board)

(play the match pair for low D once found)

(put the damper away)

(subsequent tests replay brown bells from low C upward until unmatched bells are encountered, moving on then, testing brown bells not yet matched. Replay entire scale between each new bell tested)

(move unmatched leftward; matches are placed in their graded order in its correct brown position. From this point, **do not check these matches until all brown bells have been graded**)

(play check at end)

Epilogue

In order to provide repetition, we have extensions. For example, match only the first bell and proceed in the same manner as lesson above (don't match the white D).

Or mix all brown bells and then play all the bells trying to pick the lowest bell, **without checking it with the white bell**. Continue playing through brown bells, each time picking the lowest bell and placing it into the graded brown position.

Grade by comparison. Randomize as above. Take first two bells; place one in front of the other. Keep the lower brown bell and move it down the brown row. Always keep the lowest bell as your case to compare against. After lowest is found, take the next two bells and repeat the process – **always keeping the lowest bell**.

At the end of each extension, play the full check with brown and white bells.

We grade from lowest to highest because this is how we think about music theory and how we normally read a music staff.

We can introduce the black bells after grading has been introduced. But because the pitch differences are smaller, these exercises are left for later – but all the exercises and games here can be reintroduced.

Games

Mix the brown bells at a far table; striker and damper should be at that table. Choose a white bell and pull it forward. Play it. Ask the child to go to the brown bells and find the one that is just higher or just lower.

Second game is play a few consecutive bells and have the child sing the next tone in the series.

Third game is to have 9 children, one with the mallet. Each of the other eight have a brown bell. They stand in a line and the child with a mallet grades the children into order.

January 3, 2005

Whole Steps and Half Steps

Material

Regular bell setup. Paper and pencil (or chalk and blackboard)

Age

Three to Four

Purpose

Acquaint child with terms tetrachord, diatonic scale and interval.

Prerequisite

Ability to match and grade tones.

Begin

(play check)

(play whole step)

This is a whole step

(place hand over black gap between the bells)

(repeat same two tones and same verbiage)

(play half step – E,F or B,C)

This is a half step

(place hand to show there is no black gap)

They sound very close together. There is no space between them.

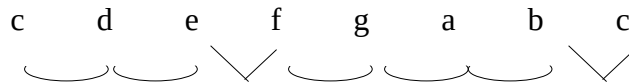
This is a half step

(repeat same two tones and same verbiage)

On another day ---

After the children have been introduced to notation, show them the following:
Let's play first two bells and name the space.

(between each two tones, tell them it is a whole step of half step)
(proceed to next two and so on)



This is the pattern for the diatonic major scale. ('dia' means “through” here, not “two”).

Epilogue

Give children to work with this pattern and have them listen with their eyes closed.

January 3, 2005

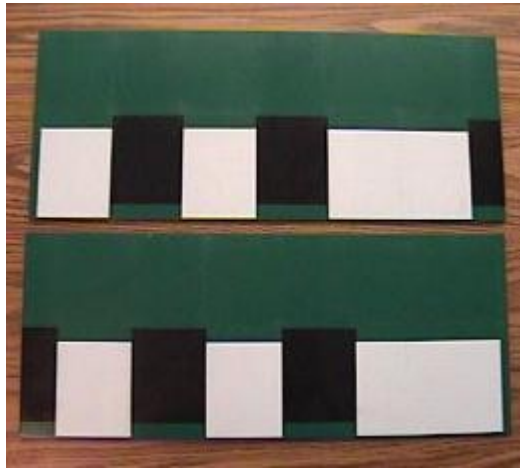
Tetrachord

Prologue

A tetrachord is a series of four diatonic tones encompassing the interval of a perfect fourth. This is the only time we will move the boards with the bells on them.

Begin

(move one board with the bells so it lined up vertically on the cabinet to show the patterns of whole-half tones are exactly the same for both boards)



Look at that! The two boards are exactly the same.

Epilogue

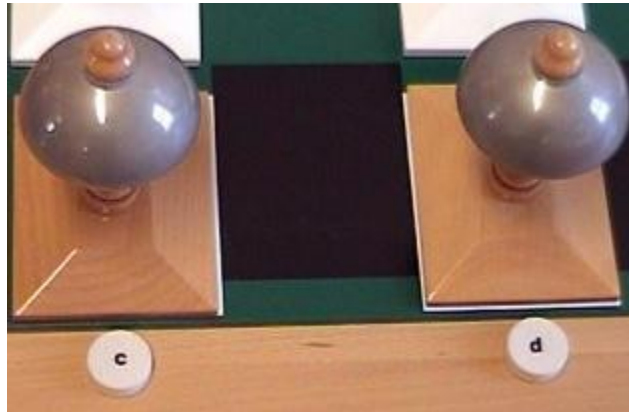
Tetra means four. The first four tones in the diatonic scale is called the first tetrachord. The second four tones is called the second tetrachord. The two tetrachords make up the diatonic scale. This is an important impression for preparing the children to work with the tone bars.

January 3, 2005

Name Lessons with the Bells

Materials

Regular bell setup. Eight white disks with note-names from the box of music symbols.



Prerequisite

Familiar with matching and grading.

Purpose

Provide ability to name the notes (pitches).

Prologue

We can use the conventions from our own culture; this may be C or it may be Do. We use a 3-period lesson to teach the names; be sure to choose contrasting bells.

Begin

First Period

(choose C and G)

(play or sing their names using the damper in-between the tones)

This is C. (play bell) **(place note names if using them for visual learners optional)**

This is G. (play bell)

(mix the bells up)

Second Period

(sing or say)

Show me C. (child does so)

Show me G. (child does so)

When I play G, wiggle your fingers.

When I play C, raise your hands.

Third Period

(play a bell and have the child sing or say the name)

On Another day ----

(take out the bells that have already been presented and add one or two more – gradually presenting all of the names of the bells – doing the 3-periods again, allowing them to skip ahead as they are ready – we don't skip but they can push us forward)

(the children can **label the keys on a piano** if you have one)

Epilogue

See if the children can do these interactions with their eyes closed as a variation. If you have a child that is just not remembering, **use the white disks with note names**: place each in front of its brown bell, in front of the regular bell setup as you present the lesson.

A good book for reference is “Joe's Got a Head Like a Ping Pong Ball: A Prairie Home Companion Folk Song Book.”

January 4, 2005

Notation

Introduction to the Musical Staff

Materials

Green boards (5 black and 1 ledger line), a treble (G) clef, plus a teacher-made box of extra ledger lines.



Prerequisite

Names Lesson for the bells.

Prologue

This is still primary level work for music in the Bells (sensorial) chapter. We have learned how to carry, play, match and grade bells.

Begin

(hold up green board)

This is a staff.

(trace **entire** lowest line) This is the first line of the staff.

(trace **entire** second up line) This is the second line of the staff.

(repeat for each line upward ... third, fourth, fifth – “there are five lines”)

(trace the lines again as you have the children name them for you)

(repeat the entire process above for the spaces between lines)

(trace **entire** lowest space) This is the first space of the staff.

: : : :

(repeat for each space upward ... third, fourth – “there are four spaces”)

This is a ledger line. (point to ledger line)

We can add as many ledger lines as we like. They can go anywhere above or below the staff. (show them the extra lines)

(create staff on the board. Illustrate how we can create new ledger lines)

This is the G-clef. Let me show you where it goes on the staff.

(put G-clef on staff with the curl on the g-line)

Epilogue

Do a 3-period with the terms above before going on to placing notes on the staff. We always count the lines and spaces from lowest to highest. We present note-names in lower-case and keys in upper case. This is not always the convention but is used here.

January 4, 2005

Note-Names on the Staff

Prerequisite

Need to know note-names.

Purpose

Memorization of note-names on the staff using the G-clef.

Material

Regular bell setup. Eight white disks with note-names – one for each note. Staff board with numbered black lines and spaces (1-8 or 1-7). Eight black disks with letter note-names on one side and numbers on the other side. A g-clef.



After the g-clef, notes are laid across the scale as seen above.

Prologue

Note names (white disks) appear, laid before the brown bells, as tone labels for the bells. We then associate numbers read from each black disk with the number appearing on the board. We are sensorially associating the g-clef note locations on the board with the note-names appearing below the bells.

Begin

(play check)

(have children help you place each white note-names in front of each bell)

What is the first one? (singing “Ceeeeeee”)

(repeat for each note)

(on the cabinet)

(place G-clef on the board. Place black disks randomly, number side up below the bells)

Place a numbered disks at the corresponding point on the line. (4) Let's see where 4 goes on this staff.

(match the number on the disk and the number on the board – turn over the disk and say the letter name)

I wonder what the name of this note is? Over the number 4 is F. Look, we have an f here.
(refer to the f-note)

(white disks are arrayed in front of the brown bells. We **match the letter name on the back of the black disk with the white lettered disk under the brown bells** - play the tone that is associated with this numbers)

Let's play an f.

(repeat for all notes)

(mix up the black disks again and let the children repeat the whole exercise)

Epilogue

FACE for spaces. Every good boy deserves fudge – for lines. Don't give these to the children, but we can use these if we forget.

Black disks are placed in a separate container to keep them unrelated as much as possible – to avoid children getting hung-up on the numbers.

Exercises

For this, we need regular bell setup, white disks with the note names, two green staff boards, extra ledger lines and the g-clef. Place the staff boards together into 1 long one. Place g-clef. Invite several children up to join in.

Take a handful of white disks with letter-names. Begin - but let children take over shortly after. Place the white disks on the staff where they belong - notation side down.

Have the child choose any line or space – go along the line or space (3rd line for example) . “What's on the 3rd line? (child turns over disk to see it is a b note). Can you play that note? Are there any other b's on the 3rd line”? Allow the child to find all white notes on that line / space – each one will be the same note – and have the child play the tone each time.

Continue until all white disks have been selected.

January 4, 2005

Music Charts for the Bells

Prologue

These boards (music charts) represent a reading activity. They can be thought of as a 3rd period type of lessons. They provide an opportunity to practice and extend prior lessons.

Children have a widely varying background in music. We must take care to match this work (exercises, etc.) to their specific level.

Material

Multiple white boards with black notes on them in various patterns. All of the notes on the boards range from low C to high C.



Purpose

Gain facility in reading and performing music. Visual recognition of note patterns and their meaning. Building a memory of note patterns.

Age

Still primary level work.

Begin

(take out first board – numbered 1, which is an ascending C-major scale)

(board appears upright in a holder similar to a piano music score-holder)
(play and sing it)

C, D, E, F, G, A, B, C (singing)

(read, play and sing all boards – based on the children's abilities)

Exercises

Child plays and sings the patterns until he knows them well. Sing the patterns without the aid of the bells. We are trying to get the point where the child can sight-read and sing the notes.

Second – teacher plays or sings one pattern the children know. Children indicate which board was presented.

Third, pair-up opposite boards (inverse note patterns – e.g., ascending and descending inverse pattern) for a more complex reading exercise. Have the child play the pattern on the bells or sing the pattern.

Fourth, give the child a chart to study. Put it aside (turn it over) and ask the child to play the pattern on the bells – without referring to the chart.

Five, give the child 3 charts to take across the room and study. Then, teacher plays one pattern and the child brings the one that was played. Add more charts to make it more difficult.

Lastly, hold up a board and have the child sing it from memory – singing in their head.

January 4, 2005

Naming Sharps and Flats

Prologue

This lessons does not immediately follow the Introduction to Musical Notes and Note Names lessons.

Materials

Regular bell setup plus 5 black bells (do not include their brown mates). Black disks with the sharp-name on one side and the flat-name on the other; there is one for each black bell. White disks with the note-names – one for each white bell. A sharp and a flat sign from the box of music symbols.



Begin

(have children label the white bells with the white disks)

(play white bell check)

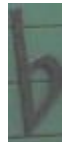
(place black bells on the board in correct locations)

(play black bell check – D, E, G, A, B)

This is a sharp sign. It means a little higher.



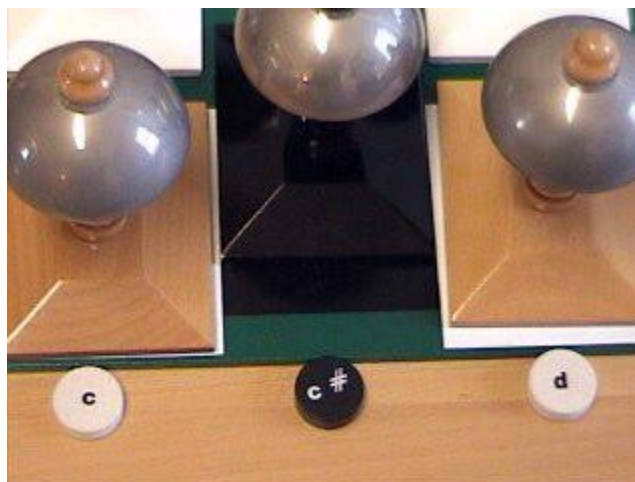
This is a flat sign. It means a little lower.



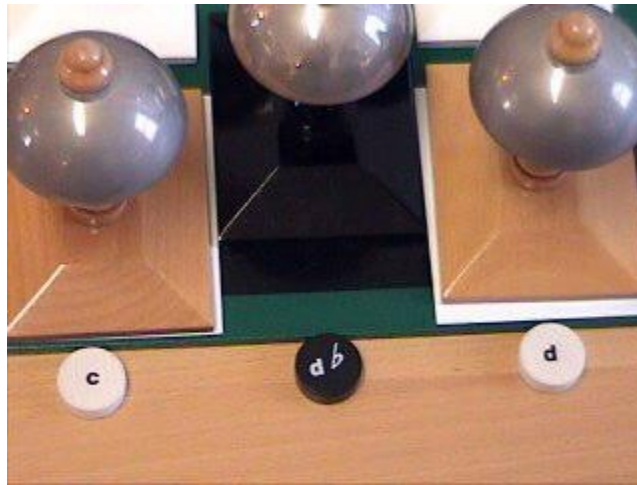
(Place black disks randomly on the cabinet with the sharp side up)

I'll teach you the names of the black bells today. They each have two names.

This is c. (play) This is c #. (play c[#]). It's a little higher. (pull c # forward a bit)



This is d. (play) This is d^b. (play d^b). It's a little lower.



(turn over the black disk to show the flat-version name)

(repeat with all other whole steps and intervals on the board – in any order)

Epilogue

Be consistent in how each whole step is presented. Once black bells have been introduced, the children can go back and do matching and grading with all the bells in the set so far – including the new black bells. Now there will be 13 pairs instead of 8.

January 4, 2005

Notation of Sharps and Flats

Material

Regular bell setup plus 5 black bells (do not include their brown mates). Black disks with the sharp-name on one side and the flat-name on the other; there is one for each black bell. White disks with the note-names – one for each white bell. A sharp and a flat sign from the box of music symbols. Green staff board. G-clef. Plain black disks (no note names). Extra ledger lines.

Purpose

To realize the black bells have two names and they take their names from the notes on either side of it. To know that naturals cancel sharps and flats. To know how to write sharps and flats on the staff.

Begin

I'm going to show you how to write sharps and flats on the staff today.

(place staff board with g-clef, in front of bells)

(hold up black sharp and flat signs from the music box materials)

You remember these from our last lesson. Sharp is a little higher and flat is a little lower.

(play brown g)

Remember where the note g goes on the staff? (second line)

(place plain black disk on 2nd line and place white g-disk underneath the board vertically aligned.

(play g[#])

What do we call that? (g[#])

(place black sharp sign and plain black disk on 2nd line and place black “g[#]”-disk underneath the board vertically aligned)

(play a)

(place plain black disk on 2nd space and place white a-disk underneath the board vertically aligned)

(play a^b)

What do we call that? (a^b)

(place black flat sign and plain black disk on 2nd space and place black “a^b”-disk underneath the board vertically aligned)

(play a)

But suppose I want to play the same old a again. We have two ways to cancel a sharp or flat.

We can also use a natural sign.

(place black natural sign and plain black disk on 2nd space and place white “a”-disk underneath the board vertically aligned)

A bar-line cancels a sharp or a flat also (place bar-line on the board)

(place white a-disk underneath)

Epilogue

Make sure children know this material well before going on to the tone-bars.

January 4, 2005

Naming Scales

Diatonic Major Scale

Material

Regular bell setup with both black and white bells and their mates. Black bells are only used in the second lesson – for the chromatic scale.



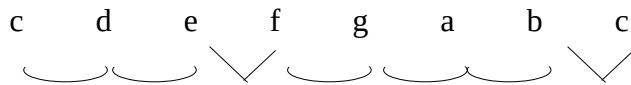
Prologue

We begin with only the white bells.

Begin

Do you remember the lesson about whole steps and half steps? We'll use that today.

(play C major scale up the brown bells - write on board or piece of paper)



(play first two bells C,D)

What is this space? (whole step)

(play 2nd and 3rd bells)

What is this space? (whole step)

(play 3rd and 4th bells)

What is this space? (half step)

(play 4th and 5th F,G)

What is this space? (whole step)

(play 5th and 6th bells)

What is this space? (whole step)

(play 6th and 7th bells)

What is this space? (whole step)

(play 7th and 8th bells)

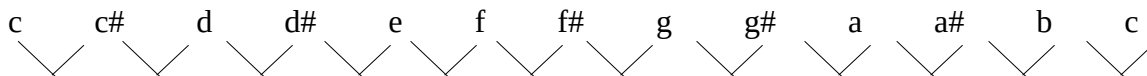
What is this space? (half step)

This is the diatonic major scale.

There are two key notes – both are C (play low and high C bells)

Chromatic Scale

(add black bells)



Begin

Listen to this!

(play the entire chromatic scale)

(play first two half steps)

What space is this? (half step)

(repeat up entire octave)

The 13 notes of this scale are all half steps!

This is the chromatic scale.

There are no key notes in a chromatic scale.

In a diatonic scale there is a place where the sound seems complete.

In a chromatic scale, there is not the same feeling of being finished.

This is the diatonic scale (play it)

Now listen to the chromatic scale (play it)

See! There is not that feeling of being anchored and completed in the chromatic scale.

Pentatonic Scale

(add black bells)



Begin

We'll only look at the black bells this time.

I'm going to play the first two black bells (c# and d#).

Now I'll play the 3rd and 4th black bells. (f# and g#)

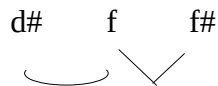
What's that space? (whole step)

(play 2nd and 3rd black bells d# and f#)

I wonder what this space is? (allow children to discuss)

What is from here to here? (d# to f) (whole step)

What is it from here to here? (F to F#) (half step)



So this interval is 1 whole and one half step the pentatonic scale has this new interval in it.

This is the **pentatonic scale and all notes have equal importance.**

Whole Tone Scale

Begin

We played scales of all half steps and scales with whole and half steps. I wonder what the scale is like with all whole steps.

The whole tone scale will have all whole notes.

(take away all bells not comprising the whole tone scale)

There are 7 notes. Let's write that on paper. (see paper notes – interval notation)



Epilogue

Once these scales have been introduced, the children can go back and

compose songs using them. They can sing them in singing lessons.

The major scale pattern can be compared, in Western music, to the base 10 number system. It is a foundation.

January 4, 2005

Writing Music

Prologue

The teacher must introduce the idea of composing by ear. One could say, “You know, I’m going to play a bell that tells what time I had to get up this morning.” (play bell 6 times, like a chime).

Suggest that we’ll play the sound of a bird. (play minor 3rd F,D like a cuckoo cuckoo pattern – birdlike or Big Ben – E, C, D, G ... G, D, E, C)

“This is the animal we saw in my kitchen. It ran under the cupboard.” (play whimsically and lightly several tones; for a large animal put your arm on the piano across many notes, for example). Falling leaf would be descending tones.

Once the child has the idea that the bells can imitate the environment, the idea is planted and they can continue to explore on the musical instruments available to them.

Music is another way to explore the environment and express their feelings. It’s another language in which they can translate their ideas.

The attitude and actions as a teacher must foster the idea that music exists as a tool for the child’s use. Even before they know much about pitch and rhythm, they can create short pieces on the bells to express an idea. This attitude of the child as composer can lead to latter compositions of more complex work which the child can notate and preserve.

This is very much analogous to work with the movable alphabet. They begin with one word, eventually sentences and one day, the child has made a completed story. Trust the child for this progress.

We make the tunes sound finished if we end on the same note that we began on. Like the movable alphabet, they don’t need to finish it at some intense pace, writing it on paper and so on. But if there is a child who wants to preserve what has been done, allow him to record the notes on staff paper – no rhythm, time signature, etc. Keep it simple to begin.

Prerequisite

Child knows how to handle the bells – or what the rules are for the instrument to be used. Later on, the child will need to know notation for writing the C major scale.

Begin

(play check - place two green board with G clef under bell set)

(play several tones to begin and place the corresponding black disks on the staff)



(play what has already been written and then...)

I want to compose a tune with you today. Who would like to add 3 notes?

(repeat for next child, adding the next 3 notes, **progressively replaying the whole tune each time 3 notes are added**)

(at end, play the entire tune)

Epilogue

From here on, the children can compose their own tunes - “stories” for fun. Their work could take many forms at this point; stories, imitation of environment, etc. Keep encouraging them to explore and compose - without the level of substantial rigor that discourages.

January 4, 2005

Pitch Dictation

Singing

Prologue

There are two stages: singing and notation. This is the oral stage and can begin shortly after the children have learned the names of the bells. **Teacher plays a bell and sings it; children sing it back.**

Material

Regular bell setup. Note, there are no white bell labels used.

Begin

(first, teacher plays a bell and sings it; children sing it back)

(next, teacher or children can play a bell and then the children sing it. Teacher does not sing here)

(after some practice with this introduce note sequences...)

(singing)

C, E, G

(we could have a child at the bell, we sing and then the child adds-on note(s))

Epilogue

We could later have the children sing the patterns on the white music boards. We can sing the pitch instead of words in songs the children know. This singing stage can go on for quite some time before notation – the writing stage – begins.

January 4, 2005

Notation

Material

Regular bell setup, green staff boards, G clef, black disks, ledger lines and possibly staff paper and pencil after work has progressed.



Prerequisite

Experience with stage one – singing dictation – and knowledge of musical notation for the C major scale.

Begin

(child faces away from bells)

Here we have the green board, ledger lines, notes and so on. I want you to record on the green board, the notes I play – in the same order.

(teacher plays notes, long gap between each - and have the child notate the tones on the green board)

Epilogue

Begin with two notes for a time. Gradually go to 3 notes and build up. They can save the work on staff paper if he likes. They can also write longer patterns on staff paper. The teacher can record that on paper and dictate that to other children; they then can use the original green board version as control of error.

We can play familiar songs for the children to notate. Anecdotally, this is a great activity for 5 year olds.

January 4, 2005

Notation of F Clef

Material

Regular bell setup. Four staff boards (two will do but it is strained) arranged in two rows of two with boards aligned vertically. G clef and an F clef. Ledger lines, white disks with note-names and if possible, a piano or keyboard.

Purpose

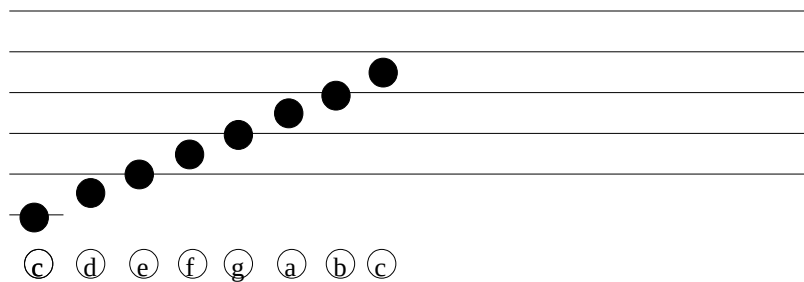
To show the children there are more than one clef; let the children find the others beyond these two.

Begin

(place white disks randomly at cabinet bottom – place four (or two) boards to begin)

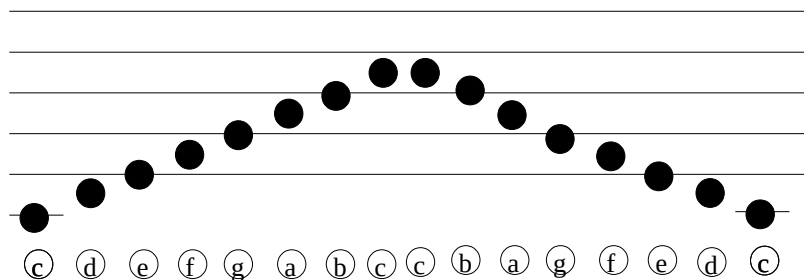
(play up the scale from middle C – begin ledger line between the upper and lower boards)

Let's record that with our white disks underneath the board. (upper boards)

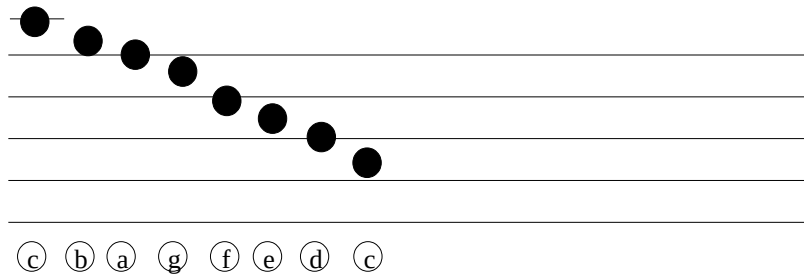


(play down the scale from high C – put middle C on ledger line between the boards)

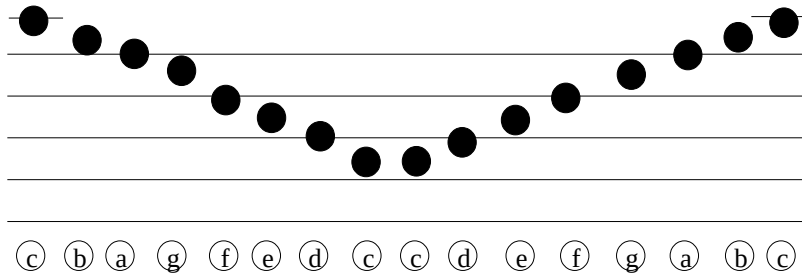
Let's record that too. (continue on upper boards)



(now play down from middle C **into the f-clef**) **Let's record that.** (lower boards)



(play up from low C). **Let's record that.** (continue lower boards)



Explore Clefs

Let's see what's on the **second space of the upper staff; that's an A note**. What about the **second space of the lower staff? No – it's different isn't it?** We didn't skip anything did we? (**repeat exploration** for other locations (e.g., 3rd line) on upper and lower staves)

We have different notes on these two staves don't we. So we need another clef. This new clef looks like this. Clef comes from the French word 'cles', meaning keys; the clef is the key that unlocks the names to the notes. (**place F clef on the lower left staff – far left**)

This new clef has two dots on either side of the 4th line. If we remember that this line is an F, we can read the rest of the notes.



Epilogue

This clef sign evolved from writing an f quickly.

January 5, 2005

Singing

Introduction

As we think about language development in the primary, the vocabulary enrichment activities expand the children's language and provide greater opportunities for expression.

When children explode into reading and writing, the richness of their vocabulary helps them. They write using words they already know. When beginning to read, we begin with words that are already in their vocabulary.

When introducing the function of words, the impressions, of the verb for example, is given with words the child already knows. So, for example, stop jumping is used – not perambulate. If the word is unknown, the lesson is lost.

In music, the child's knowledge of melodies and songs also needs enrichment. This repertoire provides a basis for later writing and reading of music. Musicians frequently compose by improvising on the works of other musicians as well as creating original melodies. So, when learning to read music, we use familiar tunes just as the children learn to read by using familiar words.

When introducing concepts like rhythm or dynamics, musical form, conducting, to name a few, we need a selection of familiar melodies with which to introduce and demonstrate the concept.

With children, especially young children, there is certain criteria for selecting songs. First, they should be simple melodies and easy to sing – without large vocal leaps required. There should be a short range of notes to not over-tax the child's vocal chords. If possible, melodies should be of a step-wise pattern. The length of the piece should be short enough to be easily memorized. Later, we build memory by including longer songs, where the adult might even sing the verses and the children read the refrain. Also, always the pieces should use repetition in note patterns. Choose songs in which the children can learn to be successful. There should be a collection of melodies that can easily be played on the tone-bars of the bells.

We want the children to experience the pleasure of the production of music, both in their own compositions and in familiar songs they sing with their classmates. The repeated experience of singing helps their ability to sing on-pitch and provides the ability to develop auditory memory. We are normally visually oriented at the expense of auditory development.

We can also use songs to fill odd time periods. Singing together at those times can help prevent breakdowns of social relationships and individual behavior.

Using simple melodies provide a base for study of other techniques. When a child already knows a song, they can reference that song during introduction of new concepts.

We can use simple melodies to introduce:

1. Playing percussion instruments
2. Improvising songs and changing the words
3. Melodies for composing his own works
4. Reading music notation
5. Study of melodic design
6. Conducting
7. Time signatures
8. Musical terms
9. Musical form
10. Dynamics
11. Tempo
12. Transposition of simple songs

Singing can also be used as a basis for discussion or reinforcement of concepts and ideas in such areas as:

1. Geography
2. History
3. Art
4. Science
5. Weather
6. Sense of self
7. Family and people
8. Friendship
9. Religion
10. Foreign language
11. Physical body and nutrition

Include classical folk and pop music in selection available in the class. Singing should not be limited to 15 minutes at the end of the day. It should be woven into the classroom throughout the day.

January 5, 2005

Teaching a Song

Material

We sang: The Carpenters “Sing a Song.” Tape / CD player with remote is helpful. Bells are needed for other demonstrations.

Prologue

Our goal is to teach 2 new songs a week to the children. Some are so simple we don't need to follow all the lessons steps below – that is for the general case. Finish each singing session with the children's favorite songs.

Begin

(give the name of the song)

(always begin on the same pitch – strike the bell to make first pitch audible)

(sing the song)

(talk about the words if necessary)

(play melody on the bells if possible)

(say the whole song as a poem – keeping words in rhythm of music)

(teacher says a phrase and then children repeat it – go through whole verse this way – repeat as necessary)

(say the whole song together and repeat as necessary)

(say the whole song silently together)

(have the children say it silently while the adult sings it)

(sing the whole song together)

(repeat the song as often as can gracefully be done in this sitting)

(mention the name of the song again and performers / composers as relevant)

Epilogue

We don't have to limit ourselves to teaching the whole class. There can be small groups as well. We can accommodate interest and readiness in this regard. Never

make a lesson longer than the shortest attention span in your group.

January 5, 2005

Singing with a Scale

Material

Bells, staff paper and pencil.

Prologue

Songs for scales are made by giving a one word syllable per note of the scale at a time. We can write on the staff for this – words below each note. Songs can be funny irreverent, serious and so on. Second way is the use the number of notes in a major scale (8) and assign words to each:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
When	my	sleep	seems	like	just	a	wink
8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1
Next	day	seems	like	I	can	not	think

Begin

(play check)

(record on staff paper what we just played)

(sing the song)

Epilogue

Use the other scales to do the same as the above – using numbers or staff to begin singing (pentatonic, chromatic and whole tone scales).

January 5, 2005

Creativity with Lyrics

We approach this in parallel to other music activities – making up tunes on the bells and so on; making up words and melodies. We can take songs and change the words to fit the child's taste or for example, what he wore to school.

Children will spontaneously make up hand motions to go with their lyrical expression. Let them be creative and free in spirit for this. We can use scale songs. Or, teach them the melody but no words to go with it; let them take it and run with it.

January 5, 2005

Singing in the Elementary Class

Public school songbooks are often contrived and intellectually insulting – often not good music too. We should remember that we still need simple songs with which to tackle singing and playing bells and other instruments.

We can include folk songs from many countries to accent cosmic education. This helps the children get a feel for the people, their experiences and values. Song from musicals and operas are often appropriate as well; choose judiciously. Use fun songs when possible.

They can use popular and historical songs – such as migration stories – farmers versus cattle-ranchers in the US, for example. There are songs about construction projects such as the Erie Canal. They can sing with a CD or tape or such a performance. Tie songs to other work the children are doing when possible.

There are rounds which are fun for the children.

January 5, 2005

Movement

Introduction

Before the human body can be used as an instrument of expression, the individual must attain a degree of control over it. Dr. Montessori understood the importance of this development. She said, “One of the things that the tiny child has to gain control over is the control of his own equilibrium. To get this balance, it is necessary for him to make efforts. Carrying the child when it is not necessary, taking him in a perambulator, or leading him by the hand, when he can walk by himself – these all present an obstacle to his acquiring balance, because the acquiring of his balance, of this natural capacity, is never given by slight or moderate effort, it always requires a great effort.” (from Maria Montessori, lecture X from the London International Training Course, April 27, 1927)

In Western culture, there are many obstacles to the development and refinement of movement. We have carpeted homes, wall to wall. Carpeting removes the auditory feedback (control of error) from the individual; things are not as likely to break if dropped nor will the child hear the scraping of the floor as he rises from a seat, for example. Cribs, playpens, walkers and strollers – too early use of shoes before the muscles are strong – living in an automobile culture, unbreakable plastic items; all these conspire to stunt our refinement of movement. Television affects under-development of attention-span and indirectly, perceptiveness. Any unnecessary help is a hindrance to development.

We must create an environment in which children can develop muscular coordination. There should be no straight-path for running, but rather provide tables and chairs to navigate around to draw the child's attention and care in movement. We need things made of glass and other breakable materials that require careful handling and careful attention. Beauty of material will also develop this careful attitude. Materials are designed to develop greater and greater precision of movement. Increasing mastery of movement increases confidence.

January 5, 2005

Movement for Control

Ground rule; children don't touch anything or anyone unless told to do so.

Exercises for Body Control and Movement

First exercise is: Children move around the room and when bell rings quietly, everyone stops and looks at the person who rang the bell. This is good to do at the beginning of the year (with refreshers throughout the year) to help the children learn to respond to the ringing of the bell when you need their attention.

Second exercise: The leader moves around the room at random. When leader stops, everyone stops. So children need to share their attention between their own movement and the leader.

Third: Leader goes around the room and when the bell rings, children reach out and touch something in the environment.

Fourth: Children move around the room and change direction when a signal is given – a sound or gesture – leader chooses. Give everyone a chance to be leader as soon as possible.

Exercises for Body Awareness

Begin

(close eyes and touch parts of body according to verbal instruction)

(use both parts of the brain by having one body part touch a body part on the other side of the body – “crossing the mid-line”)

Close your eyes. Take left index finger and touch your nose. Take your right hand and touch your knee. Take your left hand and grab your right ankle.

(with small groups or in pairs)

Find an unconventional way to say hello using a body part.

(mirror game)

Find a partner and take turns being the leader; play a mirror game where the leader moves and follower mimics every movement as if in the mirror.

(Have a particular body part lead the children around the room)

Now I want you to walk, with a particular part of your body leading you at all times.

Epilogue

These games are limited only by one's ingenuity. It's a good place to encourage creativity of the children.

Exercises for Equilibrium

Prologue

For the primary class, Dr. Montessori developed Walking on the Line to develop equilibrium. It is part of the daily material used there. She developed this after observing children walking on curbs or whatever they could find.

Because we are discussing the elementary child, we won't talk about Walking on the Line. Walking and movement do take place in the elementary class but we modify them to fit the characteristics of the second plane child. They still like to carry objects to the point that they need to concentrate to be successful. They rarely need to be told to keep challenging themselves. Use bean-bags or such things to carry on their head, for example. Don't use books, however, to avoid demonstrating lack of respect for books.

Silence Exercise

This is the ultimate movement exercise since it requires complete cessation of movement through voluntary control. Silence in exercise is restful, reveals soft sounds and the children relish the silence exercise as a fun challenge. Their enjoyment of it is in proportion to their progress toward normalization.

January 5, 2005

Movement for Expression

Prologue

Now we have control of our bodies. The children have walked without music. The music we use to get them moving should not have a strong rhythmic feel which would invite the children to walk in time. It should project calmness. Whether or not these exercises can be done in the classroom depends on the size of the room and positions of the furniture. It's ideal to do it in the classroom. When it is the right time to offer the lesson, the children are free to come or not as they choose. If we do it in the classroom, the children can initiate the exercise on their own. When not possible to do the lesson in the classroom, find another place in the building to do it. Choose small group to begin. Note that if several movements are done in one lesson, always return to walking in-between them, to calm the children, as a transition to the next movement.

Purpose

Turn the children's attention to the music.

Material

Regular bell setup, including black bells (without brown mates). Two mallets. Cards illustrating the musical terms.

Begin

(play check – children can carry objects if they like)

(we use **one mallet** here or we can use a piano or other instrument including CD or tape)

(**establish ground rule** – no touching anyone or anything unless told to do so)

(**no strong rhythm** yet – begin playing)

Be careful not to disturb the work of the others – but you can walk through the room to the music I will play. Stop when I stop and go when I go.

(play bells and let the children **walk** about)

(do this several time over several days)

On another day ... **marching**

(add a mallet – total of **2 mallets**)

Today, do what the music tells you. You don't have to carry anything.

(play the bells, allow the children to walk, run, march, etc. in reaction)

(**strike 1st and 5th bells (C and G) 8 times to set the tempo and rhythm**)

(leaving left hand on C, allow right hand to wander onto other bells)

(use a **marching rhythm**)

Another day ... **Running**

(using **only black bells**, arranged in order of pitch, placed alone at end of cabinet; 2 mallets)

Another day ... **Galloping or skipping**

(regular bells and 2 mallets)

(**strike 1st and 5th bells (C and G) in long-short-long pattern**)

Another day ... **slow walking**

(same as marching but at half the speed)

Epilogue

We don't call anything marching, for example, to not bias their reaction to our music. They will spontaneously begin to march and “run” to the music when the music queues that response. Eventually we can use the word marching.

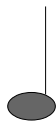
Place the bell cabinet so you can see the class; always play from the correct side of the bells. If you use the bells as opposed to other instruments, the children can play the bells subsequently on their own.

To make the music sound finished, end on the lowest or highest note of the C major scale. The children can carry one or more objects over time if they choose to.

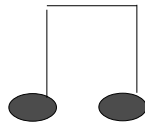
It may take time for the children to respond differently from the walking to the marching phase. We don't want to expect them to respond on schedule or to respond in the same way for every child.

We introduce notation after children have done the running and skipping. Marching is a quarter note. Running is two tied eighth notes. Skipping / galloping is a quarter and eighth note (with tail) tied into a triplet and slow walking is a half note.

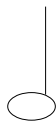
marching



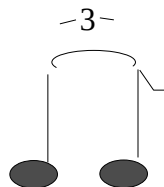
running



slow walking



skipping or galloping



Games

Divide the children into 3 groups. Give each group a card (notation card) and have each group decide where home base is (at doorway for example). Each groups chooses a leader. The children move only when their music is played. Once music stops, they return to their home base.

January 5, 2005

Accents

There are four kinds of accents that can be done. Give physical impression first and then name it afterwards. The four types are:

1. Dynamic accents: a stress produced by increased volume (e.g., **POP** goes the weasel).
(tell stories of how composers wanted audiences to awake after eating large meals)
2. Tonic accent: a stress produced by rising (or falling) pitch.
3. Agogic accent: results from a longer duration of a note. You are my **sunshine** ... my only **sunshine**
4. Metric accent: a stress resulting from a recurrent pulse in the melody.
J.S. Bach provides good examples for this where the music continues on and on, no pause at cadences.

January 5, 2005

Dynamics

Material

Regular bell setup and cards illustrating musical terms.



Prologue

Dynamics are the elements that relate to loudness and softness that change the musical experience. Rippling water that freezes and thaws, ice cream going from the freezer to the hot sun, Spaghetti in a pot that goes from stiff to soft – all are examples of natural phenomenon that provide impression of contrast similar to contrast achieved with dynamics. Others: strong versus gentle, church bell versus classroom bell, pushing an adult on a swing and the pushing an infant on the swing.

These exercises help the children feel the changes in their body needed for gentle and strong expression. After the children have had physical experiences acting these out, then the changes can be related to music and the appropriate terms can be introduced.

Musical activities can be laughing, listening, playing, etc. To introduce dynamics with music, start with a familiar piece.

Begin

When a composer wants music to be loud or soft, special words are used.

To be loud, a composer will use the word **forte** – or just the letter 'f' in the score. Here is the card (hold up forte card)

(play bell to establish pitch)

(have them sing something they know loudly)

Sometimes the composer wants music played softly. For that he uses the word **piano** or the letter 'p'. (hold up piano card)

(play bell to establish pitch)

(have them sing something they know softly)

Sometimes the composer wants music played loudly and softly in the same piece of music. (play bell to establish pitch)

(have them sing something they know while cards are held up to show how to sing, changed loudly / softly as they sing)

There are many degrees of piano and forte. You can look these up.

We also have something called **crescendo** – which means to gradually get louder.

And we have something called **decrescendo** – which means to gradually get softer.

(show the symbol cards for crescendo and decrescendo)

Epilogue

Examples of crescendo – Revel's Bolero, Groffe's Sunrise at the Grand Canyon Suite. Examples of decrescendo – “John Jacob Jingleheimer Schmidt”

Other dynamic markings are:

ff – fortissimo – very loud

f – forte – loud

mf – mezzo forte – medium loud

mp – mezzo piano – medium soft

p – piano – soft

pp – pianissimo – very soft

January 5, 2005

Tempo

Material

Regular bell setup and cards illustrating musical terms. The red verb ball.



Prologue

This is the relative speed at which a composition is to be played. It's indicated by either a word or number at the beginning of each piece or wherever tempo changes within the piece.

Begin

(give sensorial impression)

(have the children walk while teacher plays 4 notes on the C major scale up and down)

(play slow and then stop and give them the term adagio – show them the card)

This is **adagio**. (hold up card)

On the back of this card it says 'slow.'

Now let's do something different.

(play bells faster, same 4 notes)

(stop and give them term **allegro** – show them the card)

This is **allegro**. (hold up card)

On the back of this card it says 'fast.'

(now you can vary fast and slow in your playing)

We also have the term **andante** – which means walking speed.

(hold up card)

(play bells at walking speed to demonstrate)

(have the children sing something they know in tempos that do not fit the character of the music – too fast, too slow – and then just right – to give them the impression of their use)

Sometimes, we want the music to start slow and become faster. (drop the red verb ball)

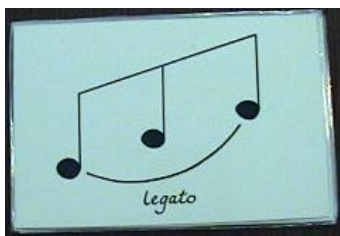
We have a term for that – **accelerando**.

Music that becomes slower, we call that **ritardando**.

Epilogue

We can also illustrate these tempo markings by singing as well as by playing the 4 notes as described above.

Use piano or voice to demonstrate these: **Legato** are notes that flow together smoothly without interruption. We give them examples, showing cards as above. **Staccato** are short notes that are interrupted. **Fermata** is a pause or hold in the music.



January 5, 2005

Rhythm

Clapping Four-Beat Measure Patterns

Prologue

This is also called echo-clapping. Have children sit in a balanced posture because it's easier to clap in time if the body is in a balanced position. Clapping exercises combine listening and movement. The children must listen to what is being done and duplicate it with body movements. This clapping helps the children develop musical memory for rhythm.

Don't look at the children as you do this – to prevent their attention from going visual instead of auditory. It's important the children have sensorial experience before they read notation.

Clap simplest first 8 patterns and build up to more difficult patterns gradually. Idea is gradually become more difficult.

You can use children's names to enunciate four-beat patterns – and relate them to the patterns in the handout. For example, Eric Ferris is likely 4 quarter notes. Make sure you write down the pattern used for names to be consistent from day to day. You can use these patterns for dismissal. “Everyone with this pattern can get your coats on.”

Introduction to Note Patterns

Prerequisites

Lots of experience with note patterns.

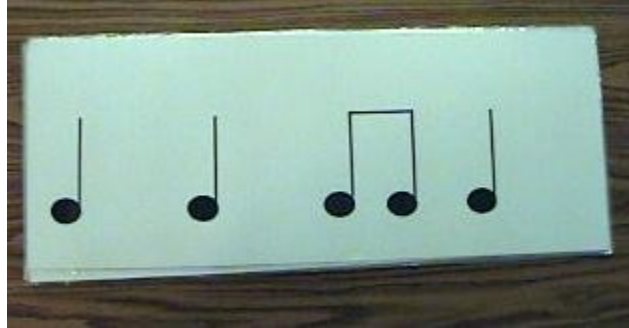
Prologue

They should be familiar with how rhythm notation looks – from cards used for the walking, running, skipping, slow-walking Movement exercises.

Begin

(hold up 4 quarter notes – clap pattern and have children echo-clap)

(hold up 3 quarter notes and 2 eighths – clap pattern and have children echo-clap)



(repeat clap patterns)

(repeat for all cards in order of complexity)

Epilogue

There is no talking necessary since this is sensorial. Take a group of children 8 or less as teacher plays pattern – then the child with that pattern holds up the card. Teacher can dictate a pattern and the children can write down the rhythm on paper – not on staff paper – but regular paper.

Material Construction

These cards need to be made. They should be large to make the right impression. The first is the quarter note (4) template. Subsequent patterns line up vertically on each quarter-beat. We need room for 3 notes per quarter note.

January 5, 2005

Naming and Notation of Note Values

Prologue

Once the children have had lots of experience, draw a chart for them which shows the relationships of the values of the notes.

Begin

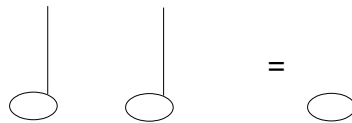
This is a whole note.

(write it)

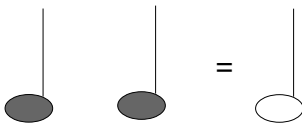


This is a half note. Two half notes equal one whole note.

(write it)

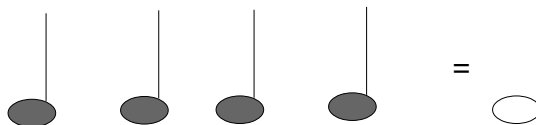


These are quarter notes. Two quarter notes equal one half note. (write it – 4)

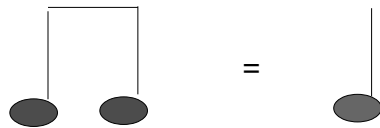


Four quarter notes equal one whole note.

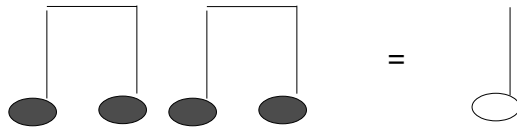
(write it)



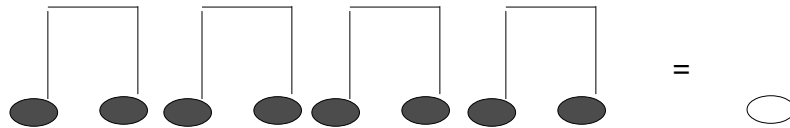
These are eighth notes. (etc.)



Two eighth notes equal one quarter note.

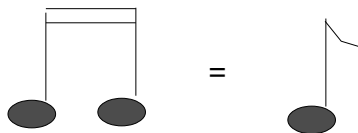


Four eighth notes equals one half note.

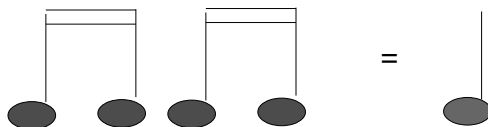


Eight eighth notes equals a whole note.

These are sixteenth notes.



Two sixteenth notes is equal to one eighth note.



Four sixteenth notes is equal to one quarter note

(continue in like fashion through whole note equivalence to 16 sixteenth notes)

(after introducing all note types – assign a whole note a value of 4)

If a whole note is worth 4, what is a half note worth? (2) (write 4 2)
(continue down to sixteenths – writing ratios as above which exposes pattern)

Suppose I assign the eighth note a value of 1. What is a quarter note worth? (2)
(keep giving them the idea of no matter what number we assign, the interrelationships are always the same)

So if in my music, I have $\frac{4}{4}$ the top number tells how many counts are in a measure.
The bottom number tells what kind of note gets one of those counts.

Epilogue

The children can go back and assign a time signature to work they've done.

January 5, 2005

Summary of Rests

Prologue

A rest is a duration of silence.

Begin

This is a whole rest.



This is a half rest.



This is a quarter rest.



This is an eighth rest.



This is a sixteenth rest.

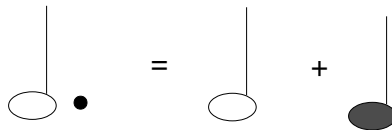


January 5, 2005

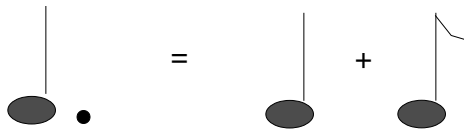
Equivalence with Dotted Notes

When you have a note with a dot, add half its value to its original value. So a quarter note is worth $1\frac{1}{2}$ quarter notes.

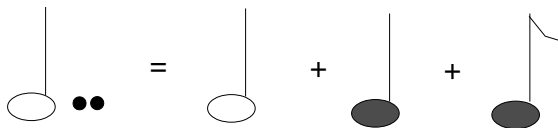
A dotted half note would be equal to a half note plus a quarter note.



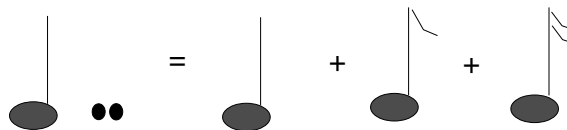
A dotted quarter note would be equal to a quarter note plus an eighth note.



And there is such thing as a double-dotted note. It has the effect of adding $\frac{3}{4}$ of the original note duration. We could have a double-dotted half note, for example:



A dotted quarter note would be equal to a quarter note plus an eighth note plus a sixteenth note.



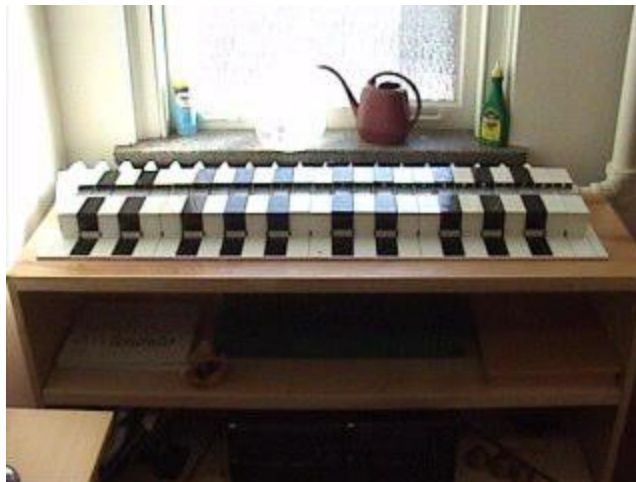
January 6, 2005

Tone Bars

Sensorial introduction

Material

Tone bar set: 2 octaves surrounding middle C (low, middle and high C inclusive), mimicking the look of a piano. There are 25 tone bars in all. Each bar is mounted in a black or white holder that simulates a piano keyboard structure. There is one tone-bar mallet – not the same as the bell striker – this is a hard rubber end. There is a teacher-made major scale pattern strip (numbers 1-8 on one side spaced for whole-half intervals, on one side, “major scale” on the other side). There is a teacher-made major scale work chart used for control of error. Finally, there are simple numbered songs on cards that are also teacher-made. We include the regular bell setup merely for transition.



Prerequisites

Ability to match and grade diatonic major scale with the bells. Knowledge of the tetrachord, diatonic major scale pattern and chromatic scale pattern with the bells. Familiarity with the staff, G-clef, note-names of the bells and their notation on the staff.

Purpose

Help the child understand a major scale can begin on any pitch as long as the pattern of the scale is preserved.

Prologue

Here we begin elementary level music.

Begin

(review the diatonic major scale (i.e., w,w,h,w,w,w,h), chromatic and tetrachord)

Today we'll do the tone-bars.

First, I want you to listen.

(play major scale on the bells)

Now watch (pull white tone bars beginning low C forward a bit and play major scale on bells and tone bars)

Now I'll put the 1 where the 8 is (put pattern strip up an octave)

(play higher major scale octave)

They sound the same, right?

(adjust the pattern strip to G key, pull F# forward, and play G major scale)

I'll start my scale here. I bet it won't sound the same

(play G scale)

It does sound the same!

Where should I begin this time?

(child chooses the beginning point. Move pattern strip '1' to that note, pull black tone bars forward to match the numbers 1-8 on the pattern strip)

Well, I bet this one won't sound the same.

(play it)

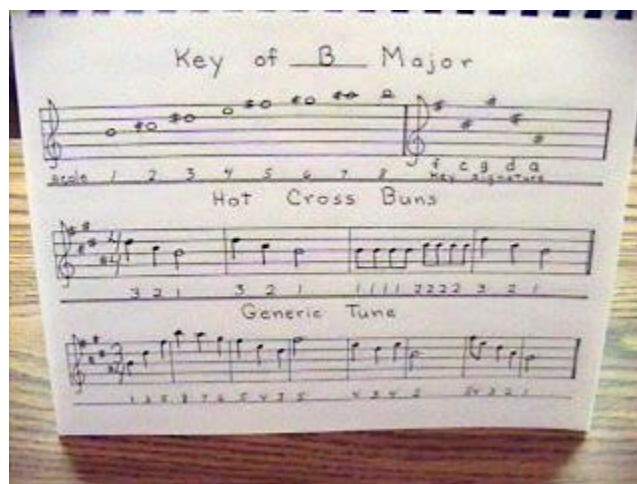
It still sounds this same! This time I had 4 black notes. (we played E major)

Can you find one that does not sound the same?

(repeat a number of times)

(eventually the children will realize any beginning point can accommodate the same major scale pattern)

Let's play a song. (play a simple song from the song cards)



(move the pattern strip around and play the same song again in different key)

(repeat)

Epilogue

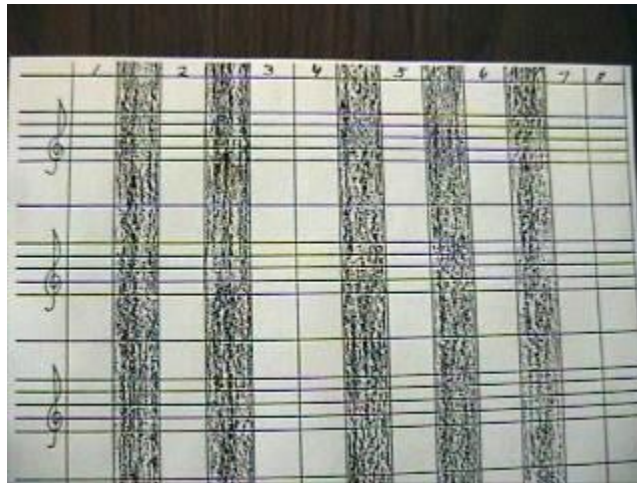
We reviewed the major scale, chromatic scale and tetrachord. We played the major scale – first pulling forward tone bars that were on our scale corresponding to the pattern strip. Then we moved the pattern strip around, moving tone-bars corresponding to the pattern forward – and played the new major scale. Then we illustrated the same notion that the pattern can be moved around, by playing simple songs – each one played in several locations. Let them come to the conclusion that the pattern is general and can begin on any pitch and still create the same relative sounds. Let them investigate whether some keys sound better than others for certain songs.

January 6, 2005

Naming and Notation of Tone Bars

Material

Bells – for transition purposes. Tone bar setup. Special staff paper for major scales and pencil. White disks with note-names from the box of music materials. Major scale pattern strip and major scale work chart.



Prerequisites

Sensorial Tone-bar introduction.

Prologue

This is a **key lesson**.

Begin

(begin with tone bars in original position)

Naming

(play the check)

Who would like to label the bells with our white disks? (do so)



(place pattern strip – put pattern strip on low C – pull tone bars of the scale forward)

(play each note on the tone bar, one-by-one (*do not play each bell*), moving each time, **one-by-one, the disks from the bells to the the upper portion of each tone bar**)

But I can keep going on the tone bars.

(adjust pattern strip to next octave and repeat process above, so that at the end, all tone bars in the C scale across 2 octaves have been labeled – play each note as you label it)

Notation

Let's look at our paper now. What do we see? Yes, we have 1 to 8 at the top of the page. We also see the special staff paper tells us where the whole steps and half steps go in the major scale. (pitches – columns, not in the scale, are blackened out)

(take off the white disks if the children are ready for that)

(push all tone bars back in original position and place pattern strip on low C, pull forward the tone bars for that scale and play them)

Let's write down what notes we just played. (do so – write the scale)

(push back the tone bars to original position)

One Flat

(move pattern to f, pull tone bars for that scale forward – then play the f scale)

There are rules for writing on the special staff paper. **Each line and space must be used** in turn on the staff – no skipping. **Each letter of the alphabet a-g inclusive must be used** in turn – no skipping. **Do not mix sharps and flats** in the same scale.

(play each note as you write)

So we have f, g, a – but what do we have here? Remember we have to use each letter in turn so we have to call this a b. But what kind of b is it? Yes, a b flat.

Two Sharps - D

Let's start on d this time.

(move pattern to d, pull tone bars for that scale forward – then play the d scale)

(play each note as you write)

So we have d and e but what do we have here? Remember we have to use each letter in turn so we have to call this an f. But what kind of f is it? Yes, a f#.

(continue on)

And what about this c? Yes, it must be a c#.

Three Sharps - A

Let's start on a this time.

(move pattern to a, pull tone bars for that scale forward – then play the a scale)

(play each note as you write)

So we have a and b but what do we have here? Remember we have to use each letter in turn so we have to call this c. But what kind of c is it? Yes, a c sharp.

(continue on)

And what about this f? Yes, it must be a f#.

And what about this g? Yes, it must be a g#.

Four Sharps - E

Let's start on e this time.

(move pattern to e, pull tone bars for that scale forward – then play the e scale)

(play each note as you write)

So we have e, but what do we have here? Remember we have to use each letter in turn so we have to call this f. But what kind of f is it? Yes, an f#.

(continue on)

And what about this g? Yes, it must be a g#.

And what about this c? Yes, it must be a c#.

And what about this d? Yes, it must be a d#.

Five Sharps - B

Let's start on b this time.

(move pattern to b, pull tone bars for that scale forward – then play the b scale)

(play each note as you write)

So we have b but what do we have here? Remember we have to use each letter in turn so we have to call this c. But what kind of c is it? Yes, a c#.

(continue on)

And what about this d? Yes, it must be a d#.

And what about this f? Yes, it must be a f#.

And what about this g? Yes, it must be a g#.

And what about this a? Yes, it must be a a#.

(repeat this pattern for whatever keys we want to present)

Epilogue

If the children are unsure where to write their notes, show them the major scale work chart. Though we are playing the scale on low C, we write the C as if it were beginning on middle C – this is okay for now. Work chart includes a mini-pattern strip that can be moved along the chart just like the strip is used with the tone bars. Do not complete the entire lesson in one sitting – break it up over a period of days.

Be sure to introduce major scales on d[#] and f^b to introduce concept of double-sharp and double-flat. Note that 'x' is sometimes used to denote double-sharp. These scales have some sharps or flats that fall on the black tone bars: c, d^b, d, e^b, e, f, g, a^b, a, b^b, b. These scales have some sharps or flats that fall on white tone bars: c[#], f[#], c^b, g^b. These scales have some double-sharps or double-flats: d[#], e[#], f^b, g[#], a[#] and b[#]. This work is true for the diatonic major scale only. Now the children can play songs in other keys.

January 6, 2005

Name of the Degrees of the Scale

Material

Tone bars. Major scale pattern strip. Labels of the degrees of the scale – names on one side and numeric degree on the other side (e.g., super-tonic and 2). Two crowns – one for king and one for queen.



Begin

(place pattern strip before tone bars on low C and pull down the tones of the scale)

(lay out labels randomly, name side up)

I have a story for you. Once upon a time there was a kingdom ruled by a king and a queen (hold up both crowns) which was 8 miles across. The kingdom's boundaries was the two tonics (play 1 and 8 of the scale, low c and middle c, place tonic cards at each location).

The king lived on the lower tonic (low c) and the queen lived on the higher tonic (middle c, place both crowns at those location) so they could effectively govern the kingdom.

Now, the king decided he needed some help governing the kingdom. So he hired a Lord High-chamberlain who lived at the dominant tone (play 5th – g and play the tone and place the card). The dominant was in the middle of the kingdom so this helped the king rule his half of the kingdom.

But the king was having difficulty communicating with his Lord Chamberlain so he hired a messenger who lived halfway between the king and the Lord Chamberlain. He lived at the mediant (play E and place mediant card).

So now he had created a strong effective framework for governing his half of the kingdom. Any music that was composed in the kingdom of c had the framework of these 3 notes. (tonic, mediant and dominant)

But the queen found it difficult also to govern her half of the kingdom so she also hired a Lord Chamberlain to help her. He lived at the sub-dominant (4th or f, play tone and place card). But just like the king, she found it hard to communicate with him so she hired a messenger who lived at the sub-mediante (6th or a, play tone and place card).

There was another member of the queen's court – her lady in waiting. She was extremely shy so she stayed by the queen's side all the time. (play 7th or b, play tone and place card) They never went anywhere without each other.

Of course the King also wanted such a helper so he hired an assistant who lived at the super-tonic (2nd or d, play tone and place card).

So these are the names of the members of the degrees of the scale that make up the kingdom of the major scale. All music that enters this scale always has to bow to the king and queen upon entering and has to bow to them before they can leave.

Sometimes, foreign ambassadors came to visit. When they visited, they stayed at the black notes in the kingdom; they added their own exotic and unique color to the music.

Epilogue

The children at this point can make up another story for another type of scale.

January 6, 2005

Intervals

Material

Tone bar setup. Regular staff paper and pencil. Pattern strip.

Prologue

An interval is the distance between two notes.

Prerequisite

Knowledge of the names of notes and their placement on the staff.

Begin

(place pattern strip at low c and play check)

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the sub-dominant)

That's a fourth.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the dominant)

That's a fifth.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the sub-median)

That's a sixth.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the super-tonic)

That's a second.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the mediant)

That's a third.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger on the octave)

That's an octave. That's a special name because they sound the same.

(have a child place one finger on the tonic of the scale and place another finger also on the tonic)

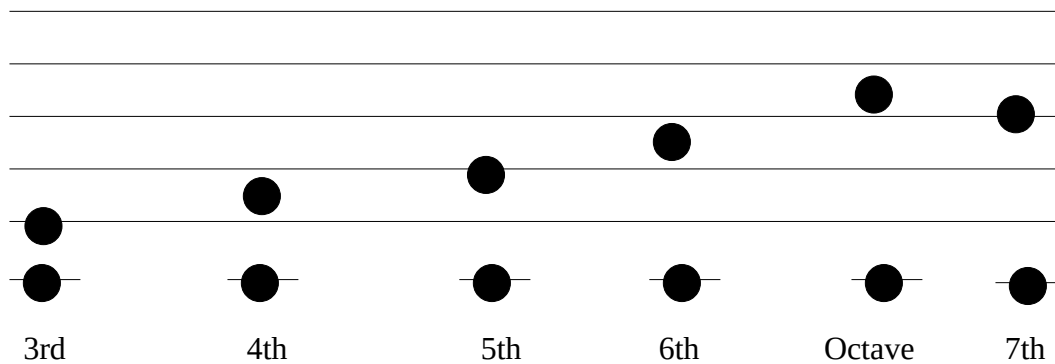
That's a prime. It has a special name because it is the same sound also.

(have child write intervals on staff paper)

(write c and e on the staff paper)

What interval is this? Let's count it. 1, 2, 3 – that's the interval of a third.

(repeat in like fashion for all other intervals, counting lines and spaces from first note)



Epilogue

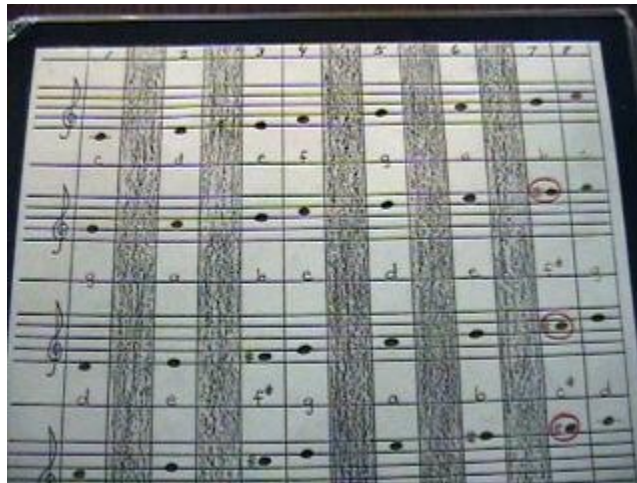
The children can write songs by manipulating particular intervals now. They need to know these terms for future lessons.

January 6, 2005

Sequence of Major Scales - Sharps

Materials

Tone bar setup. Major scale pattern strip with numbers. Special staff paper for major scales, a regular pencil and red pencil. A control card that has the sharp scales written on the special paper and if necessary, the major scale work chart. See Appendix.



Prologue

Progression of major scales is based on a sequential scheme that has mathematical precision.

Prerequisites

Knowledge of names of the tone bars. The ability to write the scales on the special staff paper and an understanding of the concept of the tetrachord

Purposes

Familiarize the children with the sharp scales and to realize that the progression is mathematically precise; the next sharp scale always begins on the 5th of the previous scale which was the first degree of the second tetrachord. Each new scale uses all sharps from the previous scale and adds one new sharp which always appears on the 7th degree of the new scale – the raised 4th degree of the previous scale.

Begin

(review tetrachord pattern with the children – using the green boards - “2 sets of four notes defined using the same interval pattern each time of whole, whole, half; the two sets are connected by a whole step to create w, w, h, w, w, w, h)

(place pattern strip on low c, pull down bars for the scale and play check)



With the pattern strip here, we have the scale of c major.

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

Now our next scale will begin on the 5th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the first tone on the second tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers)

(place pattern strip on low g, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

So this is the g major scale.

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new sharp)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the sharp we have added – f#)



Now our next scale will begin on the 5th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the first tone on the second tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers d)

So that's our d major scale.

Well if I move my pattern strip up here I run out of notes don't I. So what can we do? We

know that 1 and 8 are the same ... (child says we can move the pattern strip downward)

(place pattern strip on low d, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new sharp)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the sharp we have added)

Now our next scale will begin on the 5th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the first tone on the second tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers)

(place pattern strip on low a, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

This is the a major scale.

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new sharp)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the sharp we have added)

(repeat pattern for all sharps – e, b, f#, c#)

(use the completed staff page to count the number of sharps in each scale)

How many sharps are there in the key of c major? (none)

How many sharps are there in the key of g major? (1) **(continue for all keys)**

So these were the sharps we added in order.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

f c g d a e b

Epilogue

Be sure to play the tone when we say the name so the children's ear will be oriented and will associate sounds with words we are using. Allow the child to realize we are adding a sharp to the seventh of each new scale. Always circle the new sharp. Fat cats go down alleys eating birds!

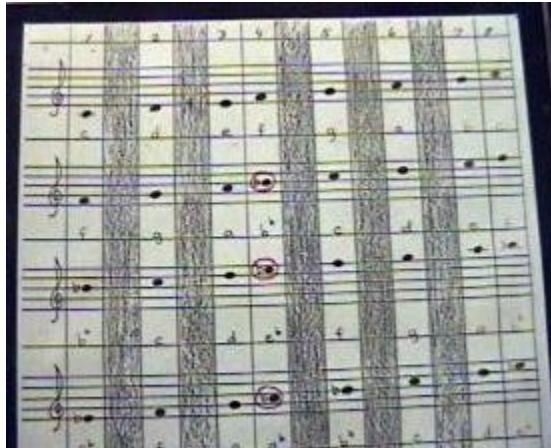
Extension - I wonder if you could keep going?

January 6, 2005

Sequence of Major Scales - Flats

Materials

Tone bar setup. Major scale pattern strip with numbers. Special staff paper for major scales, a regular pencil and red pencil. A control card that has the flat scales written on the special paper and if necessary, the major scale work chart. See Appendix.



Prologue

Progression of major scales is based on a sequential scheme that has mathematical precision.

Prerequisites

Knowledge of names of the tone bars. The ability to write the scales on the special staff paper and an understanding of the concept of the tetrachord. Knowledge of the sharp scales.

Purposes

Familiarize the children with the flat scales and to realize that the progression is mathematically precise; the next flat scale always begins on the 5th degree below the tonic of the previous scale, which was the last degree of the first tetrachord. Each new scale uses all flats from the previous scale and adds one new flat which always appears on the 4th degree of the new scale – the lowered 7th degree of the previous scale.

Begin

(review tetrachord pattern with the children – using the green boards - “2 sets of four notes)

(place pattern strip on high c, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

This is the C major scale.

Now we said that flats go down, right? So let's go down a 5th from our high c.

Our next scale will begin on the 4th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the last tone on the first tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers)

(place pattern strip on low f, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

This is the F major scale.

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new flat)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the flat we have added)

Now our next scale will begin on the 4th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the last tone on the first tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers)

Well if I move my pattern strip up here I run out of notes don't I. So what can we do. We know that 1 and 8 are the same ... (child says we can move the pattern strip downward)

(place pattern strip on low b^b, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

This is the b^b major scale.

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new flat)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the flat we have added)

Now our next scale will begin on the 4th or the dominant of this scale. This is also the last tone on the first tetrachord in our scale. That note would be what? (child answers)

(place pattern strip on low e^b, pull down bars for the scale and play check)

Let's write that down. (notate on the special staff paper with letter names underneath)

This is the e^b major scale.

Is there something different that we've added to make this scale? (we added a new flat)

Let's circle the new note in red (circle the flat we have added)

(repeat pattern for all flats – a^b, d^b, g^b, etc.)

(use the completed staff page to count the number of flats in each scale)

How many flats are there in the key of c major? (none)

How many flats are there in the key of f major? (1)

How many flats are there in the key of b^b major? (2)

How many flats are there in the key of e^b major? (3)

(continue for all keys)

So these were the flats we added in order.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
b	e	a	d	g	c	f

Epilogue

Allow the children to see that the new flat for the current scale is always added to the 4th degree of the previous scale (e.g. e^b added to b^b scale). Big elephants always do good come Friday! Also allow them to see the order of added flats is the reverse of the order of added sharps.

Ask the children what would happen if they kept going beyond the end of the special staff paper.

January 7, 2005

Key Signatures

Materials

Tone bars. Sharp and flat scales written on the special staff paper. Regular staff paper and a pencil.

Purposes

Introduce the key signatures and see how they are written; to see the way the scale looks when there is a key signature with no sharps or flats in front of the individual notes.

Prerequisites

Sequence of major scales – both sharps and flats.

Prologue

By the time you introduce this lesson, the children will have worked for a substantial time with sharps and flats and composed their own music. If you need to introduce the idea, you can say, “suppose I wanted to write this song in c#.” They would see how much work that is. And this would lead us to key signatures, transposition and so on.

Begin

(begin with the sharps and flats pages plus a piece of staff paper – add the G clef)

Sharps

What is the scale that has 1 sharp (g)

And what note is that sharp on (f)

(write that sharp on the 5th line of the staff)

What note does that scale begin on (g)

I'm going to write the scale of g major on my staff and write the notes below.

When I write this sharp on the beginning of my staff here, it means all f notes will be sharp. So I don't have to write it anywhere else anymore. It will always be f# instead of f in this piece of music.

Let's find the scale that has 2 sharps. What scale is it? (d)

What are they? (f and c)

Let's write these sharps on our staff – on the 5th line and 3rd space.

What note does this scale begin on? (d)

So let's record our scale beginning on d.

(write notes-names below each note on the staff)

(continue writing sharps and scales for keys of A, E, B, F# and C#)

Is there a way of knowing what key we are in just by looking at the key signatures?

(allow discussion and debate)

The last sharp added is the 7th of the scale – a half step below the key-name!

Flats

What is the scale that has 1 flat (f)

And what note is that sharp on (b)

(write that flat on the 3rd line of the staff.

What note does that scale begin on (f)

I'm going to write the scale of f major on my staff and write the notes below.

When I write this flat on the beginning of my staff here, it means all b notes will be flat. So I don't have to write it anywhere else anymore. It will always be b^b instead of b in this piece of music.

Let's find the scale that has 2 flats. What scale is it? (b flat)

What are they? (b and e)

Let's write these flats on our staff – on the 3rd line and 4th space.

What note does this scale begin on? (b flat)

So let's record our scale beginning on b flat.

(write notes-names below each note on the staff)

(continue writing flats and scales for keys of E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, and C^b)

Is there a way of knowing what key we are in just by looking at the key signatures?

(allow discussion and debate)

The last flat added is the 4th of the scale of the key – a fourth above the key-name!

Is there a scale with no sharps or flats in the key signature?

Sure, it's C, isn't it?

Epilogue

Now the children can compose in keys besides C major using these new key signatures.

January 7, 2005

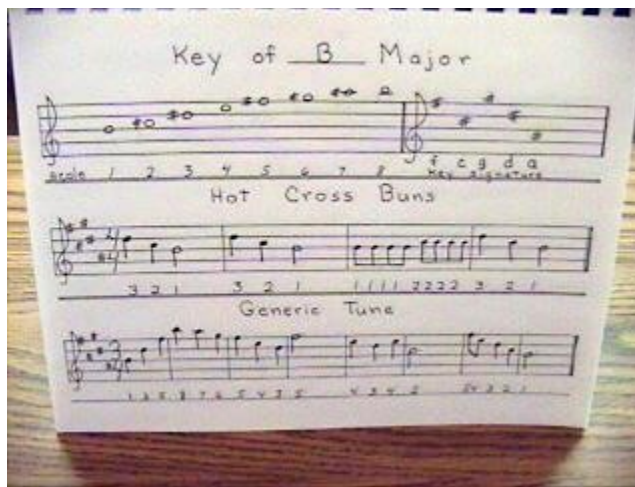
Transposition of Simple Songs

Prerequisite

Key signatures.

Materials

Tone bars. Major scale pattern strip. Special paper for transposing (different from special staff paper). Control of error book, that has the scales and songs (Hot Cross Buns and another one) written in all keys. If the children need it, we can also use the major scale work chart.



Prologue

Transposition is taking a song written for one key and rewriting it for another key.

Purpose

To learn to transpose songs into different keys.

Begin

(place the pattern strip on low C and pull the scale tone bars forward, play check)

Let's write that key-name at the top of our page, write the scale for C major and number the notes of the scale 1-8.

Now let's draw a bar line and add another G-clef and we'll write a new key signature.

Okay – now on the second staff, we're going to write the melody for Hot Cross Buns.

(fill out the melody with correct rhythmic duration and tones)

(help them with notes and note values as needed – allowing them to count and calculate)

Now let's number the tones of the scale below our melody.

Now let's transpose this – change the key of this song. What key should we choose? (A)

Okay. So let's write A in the space for the key-name on our second piece of paper.

(place the pattern strip on low A and pull the scale tone bars forward, play check)

Let's write the scale for A major and number the notes of the scale 1-8. Then, let's write another G clef to the right of our scale and write down our new key signature.

Now on the second staff of our paper, let's write our melody. What do we need first?

(G clef, time signature, 3 sharps)

Fine – what notes do we need and of what duration are they?

(help children construct Hot Cross Buns)

Now, we can transpose any song we want!

Epilogue

Point out that the stems should be an octave in length.

Appendix